

Start by taking away. The heavy winter throw, folded and put up. One of the two layered rugs, rolled. Half of what migrated onto the coffee table over the dark months, gone. A spring room is made by removal first; only then does anything come in.

What comes in is light and air. Swap a heavy curtain for unlined linen in pale sage — it moves in a draught and turns hard daylight soft. Pull the furniture a few inches off the walls so the room can breathe around it. If you change one wood tone, make it a lighter one: a pale oak side table

beside the dark sofa lifts the whole average toward the season.

Then the single living thing. Not a vase of supermarket flowers — one branch, cut from a hedge or a tree, in bud or blossom, in a tall stoneware vase, on the surface you cleared. It is the only colour the room needs, it changes every few days, and watching it open is the point. This is *shizen* — naturalness — doing what no purchase can: bringing the actual season indoors.

